

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

Below is an extract from a webpage about the top 15 most essential items for day-to-day living in Britain:

1. The Internet/wi-fi	6. Mobile phone/smartphone	11. Book/eReader/Kindle
2. Bath/shower	7. Pet cat or dog	12. Comfy sofa or chair
3. TV	8. Washing machine	13. Make-up/cosmetics
4. Laptop/tablet/iPad	9. Tea	14. Newspaper/magazine
5. Car	10. Coffee	15. Chocolate

When I think about the basic necessities of everyday life, the top of my list is a warm shower with a fresh bar of soap! Unfortunately, in a new survey personal hygiene has fallen into second place behind the Internet, which has become more important to some people than having a bath, eating or seeing their family!

A new survey asked 2000 people in Britain to name the most essential items for day-to-day life apart from food and shelter. Just under half of them (48%) said being able to use the Internet was more essential than seeing their family. About 51% reported that they could go longer without seeing their friends than using their mobile phone.

One researcher, Katie Lomas, said the findings show the extent to which technology now dominates most people's essential daily routines. She said: "What we believe to be essential is an extremely personal choice, and something that varies between individuals. For the average person, technology now dominates their list of essential daily comforts, perhaps because we are so reliant upon these items and enjoy the luxury of being connected."

In your group discuss the most essential items for day-to-day living in Hong Kong. You may want to talk about:

- which items might be different from those in the British survey
- how the order might be different in Hong Kong
- how different generations might differ in their choices
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What important things do you take to school?
2. How often do you use the Internet?
3. What are the three most essential items you carry with you?
4. How long could you go without using your mobile phone?
5. How long could you go without watching TV?
6. Do you think technology dominates your life?
7. Which could you go longer without – seeing your friends or using your mobile phone?
8. Is being connected to the Internet a luxury?